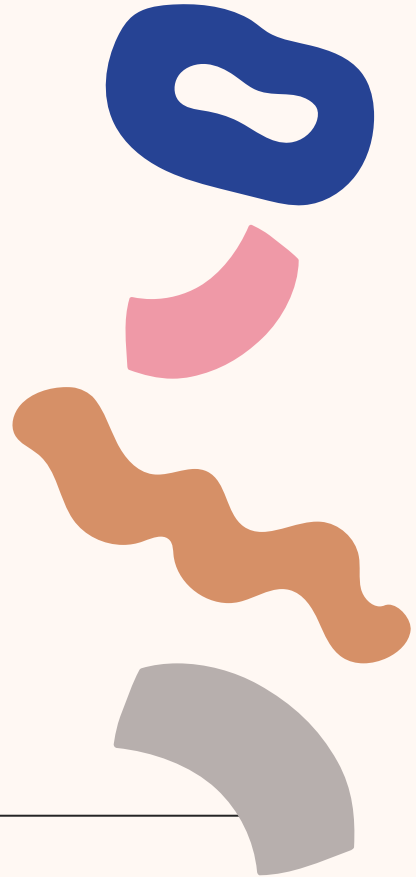

Danforth Informational Interview John Hendrix

Esther Hong



Importance of a Mentor

- **What am I looking for in a mentor?**
 - Someone who has experience who is in my field
 - Someone who has gone through application process to whatever I'm going through
 - Someone who is willing to give unfiltered advice
 - Someone who is qualified enough to tell me what I need to change/improve on
 - Ex. what is helpful or not during casing
- **Importance?**
 - With how competitive recruiting is now (in general), knowing insider tips and tricks from someone who gone through it is crucial.



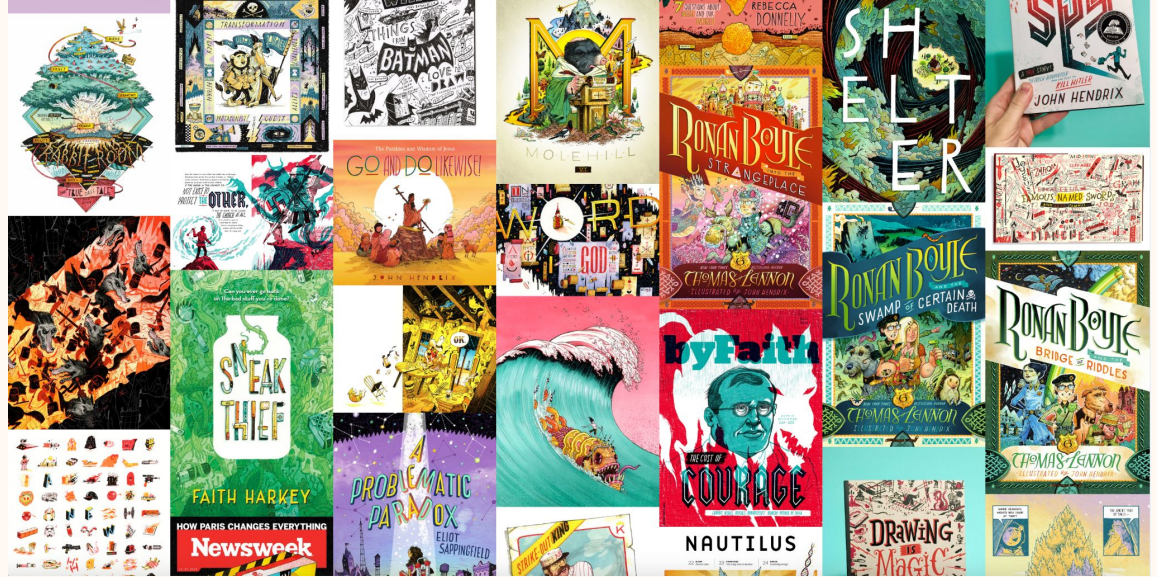
Mentor Reveal: John Hendrix

- **Name:** John Hendrix
- **Location:** St. Louis, Missouri
- **Profession:** Illustrator, author, and educator
- **Current Role:** Professor of Communication Design at Washington University in St. Louis (Sam Fox School of Design & Visual Arts)

Why am I connecting with him?

- As I continue to tie together business and art, there's a lot of networking with people who are in the business fields I'm interested in (marketing, consulting, product design/management)
- Don't want to discard art as an option
 - Speak to someone successful in art field





What did I gain?

- **Art is not always a linear process**
 - Pinterest boards, mind maps, mood boards, sketching, daily doodling, research, taking trips/adventures, etc.
- **To get started, start**
 - Just start doodling, start drafting
 - Get the ball rolling
- “Usually when students are, are working on a project, what they're most interested in, in is the result, like to get an object at the end. Right? As opposed to focused on the process. **You can focus on process.**”
 - Learning is in the journey
 - Final product is impossible to predict
 - End product cannot be manifested without the journey of starting first anyway



Unexpected/surprising to learn

- **Creativity is not driven by inspiration, it's driven by discipline**
 - Most artists (including myself) draw only when feeling motivated or “in the mood”
 - That does and will not suffice
 - Is the differentiator for successful artists
 - He says every job involves **“eating a stale bagel”**, which is showing up even when you don't want to. He advised everyone to find a job where the “stale bagel” is still doable

**Thank you
for listening!**

